

7.1 Health Hazards



A major fear factor associated with mobile phones is electromagnetic radiation

A decade or so ago, when cell phones were a novelty, they had their fair share of brickbats. The largest fear factor associated with mobile telephony was the harmful effect of electromagnetic radiation. It's a known fact that due to electromagnetic induction, a strong electromagnetic field is created, which can cause electric currents that may flow across an air gap to the ground, causing sparks. These sparks can then ignite flammable materials or gases, and can lead to an explosion or fire.

Scientific evidence for the health hazards of cell phone radiation is still disputed. The WHO has recommended that a precautionary principle be voluntarily adopted. Here, the precautionary principle is "a risk management policy applied in circumstances with a high degree of scientific uncertainty, reflecting the need to take action for a potentially serious risk without awaiting the results of scientific research."

Ever since mobile phones were launched, numerous health reports have been published by various institutions worldwide. Some reports indicate that electromagnetic radiation from mobile phones cause brain tumours and can even result in Alzheimer's